

HYCLE IN ACTION / DAY 2, 14:00

The factory is the **easy** part.

You built a factory. Now change the organization that decides what it builds.

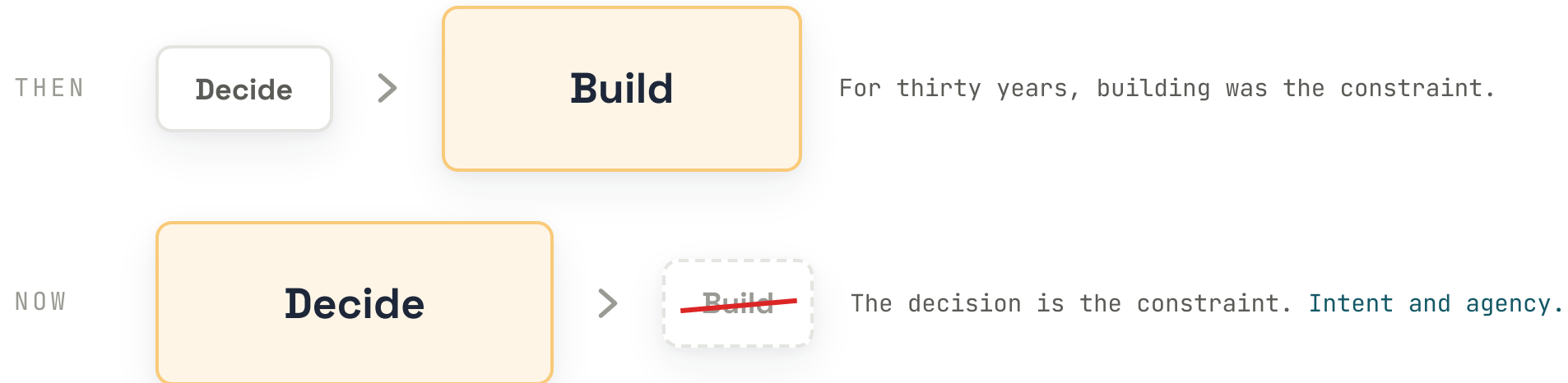
Andreas Stephan

A DAY AND A HALF AGO, YOU BUILT A SOFTWARE FACTORY

It works.

And on its own, it will not make your company better. It can make it worse. For the next twenty minutes, let me convince you why, and what to change.

The bottleneck moved.



WHAT SITS UPSTREAM NOW

The constraint is the decision.

WHAT TO BUILD

Intent

What the customer actually needs. The one thing an agent can never hand you.

THE ABILITY TO ACT

Agency

Germans call it Handlungsfähigkeit: competence, authority, and information in the same place.

When execution was slow, you never noticed these were the real bottleneck. Now building is instant, and the slow decision is exposed.

THE TRAP

There is nothing so useless as doing efficiently that which should not be done at all.

Peter Drucker

Two futures follow from here. Both bad.

Speed up execution, leave the decision where it is.

FUTURE ONE

Faster waste

Build the wrong thing in a day
instead of in two weeks

The build trap on a faster engine
more code, none of it closer to a customer

The empty backlog is a smoke alarm
you build faster than you can decide

FUTURE TWO

Rationalization

Same output, fewer people
cut cost, hold output

The market rewards it
in the short term

Not innovation
cheaper while you wait to be disrupted

RATIONALIZATION, MADE REAL

Block, February 2026.

40%

OF STAFF CUT

4,000+

PEOPLE

AI named as the reason. The stock went up. A real strategy that pays in the short term. Just do not call it innovation.

Sources: CNN, Fortune, 2026

TWO FUTURES, ONE NON-CHOICE

These are the same future.

Both are what happens when you leave the decision where it is. The third path, the one where the factory makes you better, you have to build. With structure, not tools.

WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGES

Three shifts. None of them technical.

What actually changes

01 Aim at decisions, not execution

Stop measuring how fast you build. Time your slowest decision. That number is your real cycle time.

02 Push agency down, inside a frame

Competence, authority, information where the work happens. The frame is strategy: what you will and will not do.

03 The roles blur

Form intent, decide what matters, ship by afternoon. Discovery is the job an agent cannot do, and it is becoming yours.

You do not need permission to start. Stop outsourcing discovery to one PM. Agree what you do the moment a decision is blocked.

THIS ALREADY HAPPENED

Scrum was a buffer for when code was expensive. I killed it.

Andreas Stryz, CTO at FINN, 2026

Micro teams. One PM, a few engineers. Each owns one KPI, not a backlog.

WHY THIS IS HARD

What is yours, and what is not.

YOURS, ON MONDAY

Your team

Build discovery in. Agree how you act when a decision is blocked. Prove it on one team, with a number that moved. Nobody upstairs has to approve that.

NOT YOURS ALONE

Authority

You cannot refactor who is allowed to decide from inside your team. That takes uncomfortable conversations with people who are not in this room.

The frustration when a good idea dies in an approval queue is not noise. It is data. It points at the structure that has to change.

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

hycle

An open inquiry into what happens when execution stops being the hard part. Written as hypotheses, not answers. Come argue with us at hycle.org.

BEFORE NERMIN, SIT WITH THREE QUESTIONS

For your own organization

- 01 **A decision you cannot make today**
that you would need to make to use this factory fully.
- 02 **Who holds the authority and the information you are missing**
and when did you last actually talk to them?
- 03 **One structure to change first**
a role, a cadence, an approval. Which one?

You built the factory.

Now go change the organization that decides what it builds. Nermin, over to you.